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Decades of democracy: insights into the political landscape of Chile

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Chile was long considered a beacon of stability in a turbulent region, until the 2019 social outburst and two failed constitutional processes prompted a reassessment. We argue that the reliance of much of the literature on national aggregates obscured underlying dynamics that could have raised institutional alerts, and perhaps even diverted the course of the crisis. To test this claim, we focus on the Chilean party system as it has been tied to the fateful events and ask whether inferences would have been different had alternative data been considered. In this effort, we introduce the Chilean Political Landscape Dataset (CPLD), a standardized longitudinal dataset of district-level electoral outcomes and indicators from 1989 to 2024 that includes more than 5300 observations across legislative, regional, and municipal contests. The dataset allows us to highlight meaningful gaps between prevailing explanations and observed patterns, showing why district-level evidence is necessary to identify the sequence, scope, and ideological contours of change. We show that more detailed data suggest that fragmentation began well before 2015, that the party system was drifting leftward over time, and that fragmentation occurred asymmetrically, impacting parties on the left more than those on the right. We argue that this had previously gone untested and unfound because of the lack of data and conclude by illustrating its relevance by showing additional applications of the CPLD, including assessments of social structures and institutional design.

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Decades of democracy

Up until the social outburst of 2019, Chile had long been regarded as one of Latin America's most stable democracies. Much of its reputation had rested on foundational analyses, which emphasized electoral continuity (Morgenstern et al., 2014; Siavelis, 2002, 2005), persistent and broad coalitions (Alemán et al., 2021; Carey, 2002), and stable legislative voting patterns (Alemán & Saiegh, 2007).

While these accounts provided valuable insights for the decades that followed the transition to democracy, they also generally relied on aggregate-level data and first-tier elections that systematically smoothed over significant variations across districts, institutions, and political characteristics. The question, then, is if the “thicker” scope contributed to accurately capture when and how Chile's political system was changing, or instead to obscure some of the dynamics that are now known to have been driving transformations from below and from within.

The issue is not simply methodological. Comparative politics frequently evaluates democratic quality, the consequences of electoral reform, and the evolution of party systems using national measures such as the effective number of parties, disproportionality indices, or aggregate turnout rates. Yet if these measures conceal substantial subnational heterogeneity (see Stoll, 2008), they can significantly misrepresent the mechanisms through which change comes about.

Chile offers a particularly relevant case to study possible discrepancies. Since the return to democracy in 1989, it experienced multiple institutional reforms, culminating in the 2015 legislative overhaul that replaced the binomial arrangement with a wider-ranging proportional representation system (see Gamboa & Morales, 2016), while also undergoing broader challenges to political representation (Castiglioni & Kaltwasser, 2016; Siavelis, 2016), including declining trust in parties (Carlin, 2011, 2014), and the protest cycle of 2019–2020 that ultimately culminated in the constitutional reform process of 2021–2023 (Bunker, 2025b). Together, these developments provide an optimal foundation to study not only discrepancies that may arise between national aggregate level trends and district level data, but also the greater trajectory of the Chilean party system.

This article introduces the Chilean Political Landscape Dataset (CPLD) as a resource designed to address the gap. Currently covering more than three decades and over 5300 district-level electoral outcomes across legislative, regional, and municipal contests, the CPLD provides comprehensive information on candidate numbers, coalitions, district magnitude, turnout, disproportionality, and measures of fragmentation. The dataset's longitudinal and hierarchical structure enables both short-term and long-term analysis and supports the application of methods such as hierarchical modeling, spatial analysis, and time-series cross-sectional analysis.

To illustrate the limitations of existing aggregate accounts, and how they can mask actual trends taking place, this article presents three questions that focus on three areas which, although not initially framed in this way, are now all associated with Chile's 2019–2023 crisis, and that therefore provide a useful lens for reassessing the instability that hit the once most stable country of the region from a subnational perspective.

The first of the questions concerns the timing of party system fragmentation. For many years, up until the social outburst of 2019, the prevailing view held that fragmentation began only after the 2015 legislative reform, which created larger district magnitudes and lowered barriers to entry (Gamboa & Morales, 2016). Although this view continues to be influential (see Jofré & Cabezas, 2025), subsequent developments suggest that fragmentation had already been underway before the reform in ways that national figures obscured.

The second question examines the ideological structure of the party system. Scholarly debate has often treated Chile as composed of two enduring blocs, one center-left and the other center-right, and many accounts still frame the system in these terms (Visconti, 2021). More recent literature has instead shown that the party system may have restructured into three or even four blocs (Bunker, 2018). Yet newer accounts suggest that this bipolar structure or instead undergone a more profound ideological reconfiguration.

The third question links the first two by focusing on the relationship between fragmentation and ideology. It has loosely been assumed that fragmentation is broadly symmetrical across the political spectrum, without disproportionately benefiting any side. Recent crises, however, invite a closer look at whether fragmentation has in fact been uneven, advantaging some parties and coalitions more than others.

Addressing these three questions does not only shows how subnational level data could have served to warn of the incoming 2019–2023 crises, but also to illustrate that broader theories of party system change, such as asymmetric fragmentation, can be better studied from the district-level evidence.

The remainder of this article is structured as follows. The next section explains why district-level analysis matters and frames the three guiding questions that motivate the study. Section 3 introduces the Chilean Political Landscape Dataset (CPLD), detailing its scope and construction. Section 4 uses the dataset to address the questions directly, showing that the gaps between aggregate accounts and observed patterns are real. Section 5 extends the analysis by illustrating additional applications of the CPLD, including assessments of disproportionality, nationalization, and the effects of institutional reforms. Section 6 concludes by reflecting on what these findings imply for understanding Chile's evolving political landscape and for the study of party system change more broadly.

Why district-level data matters in Chilean electoral studies

The study of Chilean electoral politics has traditionally relied on aggregate or national-level indicators. Scholars have examined trends in the effective number of parties, the stability of coalitions, or aggregate patterns of turnout to characterize the trajectory of Chile's democracy since 1989. These approaches have provided a valuable baseline for understanding broad developments, including the durability of the Concertación coalition (Carey & Siavelis, 2003; Siavelis, 2002), the influence of the binomial system (Cabezas & Navia, 2005; Magar et al., 1998), and the consequences of related institutional reforms (Briebe & Bunker, 2019; Bunker, 2018). Yet, as in many other democracies, reliance on national indicators inevitably conceals important heterogeneity (see discussions in Singer & Gershman, 2018; Singer & Stephenson, 2009). Districts vary widely in their demographic, socio-economic, and institutional characteristics, and electoral dynamics unfold within these local arenas before they aggregate into national patterns.

A large comparative literature has demonstrated the risks of focusing solely on the national level. Studies of party system fragmentation, for example, stress that effective numbers of parties can mask important subnational variation (Bochsler, 2022; Cox, 1997; Laakso & Taagepera, 1979; Rich, 2015; Singer, 2015). Research on electoral reform has shown that institutional effects often differ across contexts: the same change in district magnitude can produce distinct results depending on local competition and social structure (Banerjee & Rich, 2016; Carey & Hix, 2011; Harfst et al., 2018; Lucardi, 2019; Potter, 2018). Similarly, work on party system nationalization highlights that the consistency of support across districts is central to understanding representation

and stability (Golosov, 2016; Hicken & Stoll, 2017; Lago & Montero, 2014; Morgenstern et al., 2009). Chile, with its long democratic trajectory and repeated reforms, represents an ideal case for applying these perspectives, but only if appropriate district-level data are available and measured consistently across space and time.

Reexamining the mask of stability. The first section first presented the notion of stability in Chile as an idea that was shattered by the social outburst and the two failed constitutional processes that followed. If nothing else, these two interconnected events forced a reexamination of the link between a party system long regarded as regionally successful and fail-safe, and the possibility that underlying tensions were masked.

More recent literature links the developments to occurrences within the party system (e.g., Bunker, 2025b). For this reason, it is especially important to revisit areas where conventional wisdom has been strongest and to ask whether conclusions based on aggregate data obscured the warning signs. Three questions frame this reexamination.

The first question concerns the timing of party-system fragmentation, a factor often associated with political instability (Mainwaring & Zoco, 2007; Pildes, 2021). In this regard, a dominant view in Chilean literature is that fragmentation only began after the 2017 legislative election (Bunker, 2018), which abolished the binomial system and introduced larger multimember districts (Gamboa & Morales, 2016). In this traditional account, institutional design had constrained competition for more than two decades, and the reform released pent-up pressures for new actors to emerge. While it remains a common interpretation (Jofré & Cabezas, 2025), it is still relevant to ask whether fragmentation might already have been underway before the reform in ways that national figures concealed.

District-level results provide the necessary leverage to answer this question, as they reveal whether patterns of competition were changing at the subnational level before legislative reforms altered the first-tier rules of the game.

The second question concerns the ideological structure of the Chilean party system, which is often associated with the system's capacity to channel representation (Dalton, 2021; Kim et al., 2010). While traditional literature points to stability with a center-left bloc and a center-right bloc alternating in dominance before the entry of new forces in post-reform Chile, it remains unclear whether this fading stability was masking more than just the rise of third parties. Given the challenges to political representation that culminated in the 2019 outburst and constitutional failures, it is thus still relevant to ask to what extent the party system has exhibited continuity and to what extent it had undergone ideological reconfiguration leading up to the events in question.

Here too, subnational data can help answer the question, as it is impossible to detect system-wide ideological shifts with aggregate data from first-tier elections alone.

The third question links these two dimensions: When fragmentation occurs, how does it interact with ideology? One possibility is that fragmentation is distributed evenly, affecting all sides of the spectrum; another is that it is asymmetric, disproportionately benefiting certain blocs and altering the balance of representation. Considering the ways partisan competition shaped not only regular representative elections post social outburst, but also the constitutional process, it is still relevant to ask whether fragmentation has in fact been uneven, impacting some ideological sectors more than others.

As above, district-level data can also help understand this issue, as it concludes that one political sector benefits more than another by using aggregate level risks ecological fallacy.

The Chilean Political Landscape Dataset (CPLD)

Despite the proven benefits of district-level analysis, comprehensive data for Chile have been scarce. Previous efforts have typically focused on particular elections, isolated cycles, or limited sets of variables, leaving important gaps in coverage. No single resource has provided a consistent and comparable record of electoral competition across levels of government throughout the democratic period. This has hindered both descriptive and theoretical work. Researchers have lacked the tools to test whether institutionalist theories developed elsewhere apply in Chile, to measure long-term trends in fragmentation and ideology, or to connect local electoral dynamics to national political crises.

This study addresses this gap by introducing a dataset that consolidates district-level electoral outcomes across more than three decades. In doing so, it provides the foundation for revisiting the questions outlined above and for situating Chile within broader comparative debates.

The Chilean administrative scaffolding. Chile's electoral system is organized in a nested fashion, with contests held at national, regional, and local levels. Each tier employs distinct but interconnected electoral rules, and together they structure the arenas in which political parties compete.

At the national level, the president is elected in a two-round system, while the bicameral legislature combines proportional representation for both the Senate and the Chamber of Deputies, with varying district magnitudes (between 2 and 5 for the Upper chamber and 3 and 8 for the Lower chamber). At the regional level, governors are directly elected in a two-round system, and regional councils use proportional representation (in districts that range between 3 and 11). At the local level, mayors are elected by plurality, while municipal councils use proportional representation (seats are distributed based on district population size and can be either 6, 8 or 10).

Together, these arrangements create a complex institutional environment in which parties are forced to adapt their strategies across multiple arenas of competition.

The Chilean Political Landscape Dataset. The Chilean Political Landscape Dataset (CPLD) is designed to capture this complexity. It compiles district-level results for more than 5,300 electoral outcomes spanning the democratic period from 1989 to 2024 (see Table A1 in the Appendix). The dataset covers legislative, regional, and municipal elections, making it one of the most comprehensive resources available for studying electoral politics in Chile. By standardizing data across multiple levels of government and over more than three decades, the CPLD provides a consistent foundation for analyzing how institutional reforms, social cleavages, and party strategies have interacted over time.

The CPLD includes information on key electoral variables (see Table A2 in the Appendix). For each election, it records the type of contest, the electoral system in place, the district or electoral unit, the number of candidates and lists (coalitions, parties, or independents), and vote shares.

It incorporates district characteristics such as magnitude, assembly size, and indicators of social diversity. It also provides derived measures widely used in the study of party systems, including the effective number of vote-winning and seat-winning parties (Laakso & Taagepera, 1979), multiple indices of disproportionality (Gallagher, 1991; Loosemore & Hanby, 1971; Rae, 1967), and measures of ideological orientation. The

measurement and equations used to derive the indicators are specified in the associated codebook.

A distinctive feature of the dataset is its treatment of coalitions and reforms. Chilean politics has been marked by shifting alliances, with multiparty coalitions often competing against individual parties. The CPLD carefully codes these arrangements, ensuring that measures of competition and representation reflect the actual structure of contests. It also tracks changes in electoral rules, such as the 2015 reform that increased district magnitude and abolished the binomial system, allowing researchers to examine how outcomes vary across institutional contexts.

The dataset's breadth allows for several types of analysis. At the descriptive level, it provides a clear record of how many parties and candidates contested elections, how coalitions formed and dissolved, and how outcomes varied across districts. At the theoretical level, it enables tests of longstanding debates: whether Duvergerian predictions hold in Chile, how fragmentation relates to social diversity, and how institutional reforms reshape representation. Its longitudinal design allows for the study of trends across more than thirty years, while its district-level granularity makes it possible to examine regional variation and subnational dynamics.

Importantly, the CPLD directly supports the investigation of the three questions outlined above. First, by providing consistent measures of fragmentation at the district level, it allows researchers to determine whether fragmentation truly began only after the 2015 reform or whether it was already underway in earlier cycles. Second, by merging with indicators of ideological alignment, it makes it possible to evaluate whether the party system has been stable or shifting over time and across regions. Third, by linking fragmentation and ideological scores, it provides the means to examine whether fragmentation has been symmetrical or has disproportionately benefited certain blocs.

In sum, the CPLD fills a critical gap in the study of Chilean politics. It consolidates dispersed information into a coherent dataset, provides variables central to the study of party systems and electoral institutions, and allows for both descriptive and theoretically driven analysis. By situating Chile within comparative debates on institutional design, fragmentation, and representation, the dataset offers a platform for advancing both national and cross-national research.

Answering questions using the CPLD

This section illustrates how the Chilean Political Landscape Dataset (CPLD) can be applied to address the three questions outlined earlier: the timing of fragmentation, the stability or transformation of ideological competition, and the interaction between fragmentation and ideology. In addition, it highlights other potential applications that underscore the dataset's broader value for the study of Chilean electoral studies and comparative politics more generally.

Party system fragmentation over time. Returning to the first question, which stems from the idea that the 2019 social outburst and subsequent constitutional process failure are associated in some ways to the sudden fragmentation of the party system, it is important to reconsider the timing of party system fragmentation. The conventional view hitherto is that fragmentation began only after the 2015 legislative reform, which abolished the binomial system and expanded district magnitude. Read at the national level, aggregate indicators appear consistent with this reform-centered narrative, and much of the literature interprets the 2017 election as the turning point that triggered a qualitatively different party landscape.

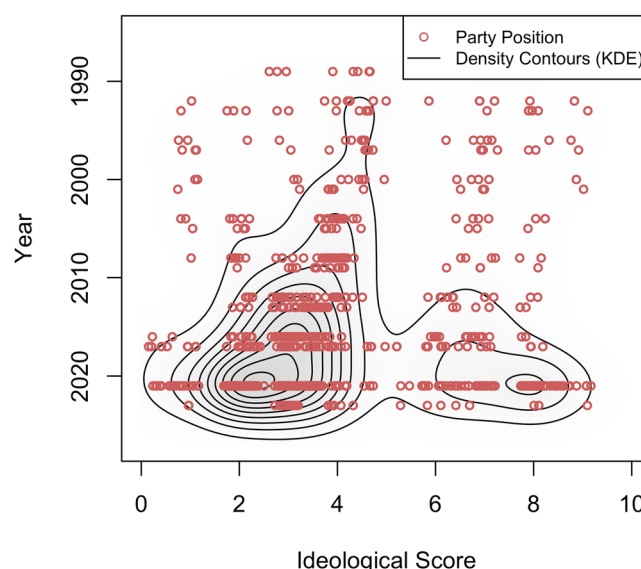


Fig. 1 Party system fragmentation over time at the district level in Chile, 1989–2023. This figure displays contour lines representing the distribution of party system fragmentation across Chilean electoral districts for all parties that competed in national elections. The x-axis represents ideological position, and the y-axis represents election year (1989–2023). The contours indicate regions of higher or lower concentration, identifying where most districts cluster in terms of fragmentation intensity. The figure shows a noticeable upward shift in fragmentation beginning around 2009–2010, signaling an expansion of party competition during that period. Source: Author and Bunker (2025b, 2025c).

Figure 1, duplicated from Bunker (2025b), which is based on district-level data from the CPLD, suggests a different sequence. Because the dataset tracks the effective number of parties by votes and by seats (ENPv and ENPs) across all electoral contests since 1989, it captures local dynamics that national summaries conceal. The figure, which shows the density of political parties over time, shows visible signs of dispersion emerging by the 2009 election, indicating that fragmentation was underway well before the reform. From this perspective, institutional change accelerated an existing trend rather than initiating it.

The consequences of the misreading may be significant. By treating fragmentation as a post-reform phenomenon, both scholarship and policymaking may have underestimated the long gestation of competitive pressures. In turn, this delayed recognition may have contributed to reforms being designed as if they were unleashing something new, rather than deepening a process already in motion. In the same way, earlier identification might not have prevented fragmentation, but it could have encouraged timelier adjustments in electoral design, party coordination, and the calibration of thresholds, reducing the unintended consequences that amplified instability both before and after 2019.

The ideological structure of electoral competition. Concerning the second question, much of the literature has emphasized the stability of Chile's ideological structure. This stability has also been associated in different ways with the social outburst, syndicating it as a pressure pot for its extreme entrenchment. Indeed, since the 1989 transition, the system was commonly portrayed as anchored in two enduring blocs, one center-left and the other center-right, alternating in dominance with little change in their relative positions. And even after the clear rise of a third, and maybe fourth alternative, the size and characteristics of the

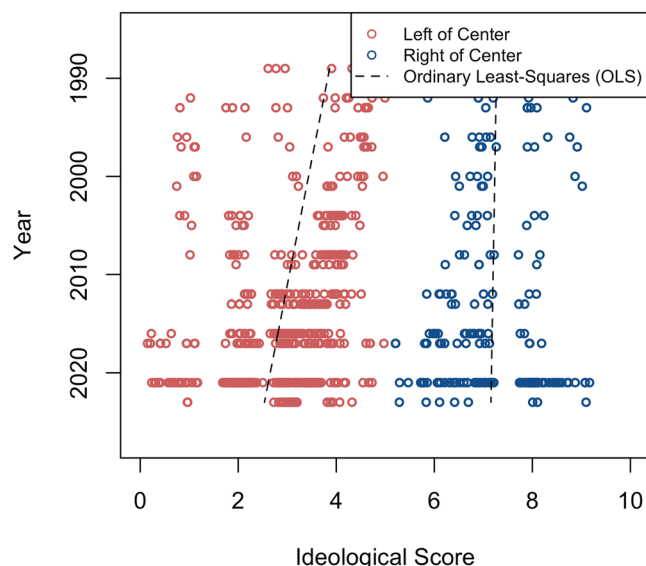


Fig. 2 Party system positions at the district level in Chile, 1989–2023.

This figure plots the estimated ideological positions of Chilean parties at the district level across all national elections from 1989 to 2023. The x-axis represents ideological position, and the y-axis represents election year. Regression lines differentiate left- and right-leaning parties, showing that left-wing parties have gradually shifted further to the left over time, whereas right-wing parties have remained comparatively stable or drifted slightly toward the center. Source: Author and Bunker (2025b, 2025c).

system were still studied as a factor related to both the pressure and release of pressure that led to the known developments.

Figure 2, duplicated from Bunker (2025b), qualifies this view. While it is true that three or four major coalitions competed in elections over time, at the district level, parties divided into individual entities, shifting alliances, and competing intermittently. In this way, the picture that emerges is not related to the number of blocs in specific elections, but to the general movement of the party system over time. Indeed, the figure highlights a gradual leftward shift in the system's center of gravity, with the modal positions of competitive districts and the median coalition positions edging left over time.

This overlooked drift might have had important implications for the political developments of Chile. Because national aggregates generally gave the impression of stability, coalitions often failed to recalibrate their programs or adapt to changing voter alignments. Earlier recognition of the leftward shift might have spurred more deliberate strategic adaptation, improved responsiveness to regional dynamics, and moderated the representation gaps that later fueled discontent. Instead, adherence to the larger-bloc narrative likely delayed both adjustments and reactions and left the party system poorly positioned to absorb the challenges that both culminated in the social outburst and constitutional failures.

Fragmentation and ideology in interaction. Concerning the third question, the relationship between fragmentation and ideology raises a critical distributional issue, especially considering the above. If fragmentation had occurred symmetrically, then both the left and right would have developed proportionally, regardless of the drifting nature of the party system. But if one sector developed more than the other, this could have led to an overcompensating influence over the greater political agenda. The prevailing assumption, the null hypothesis, thus far has been symmetry. If the effective number of parties rises, it increases in

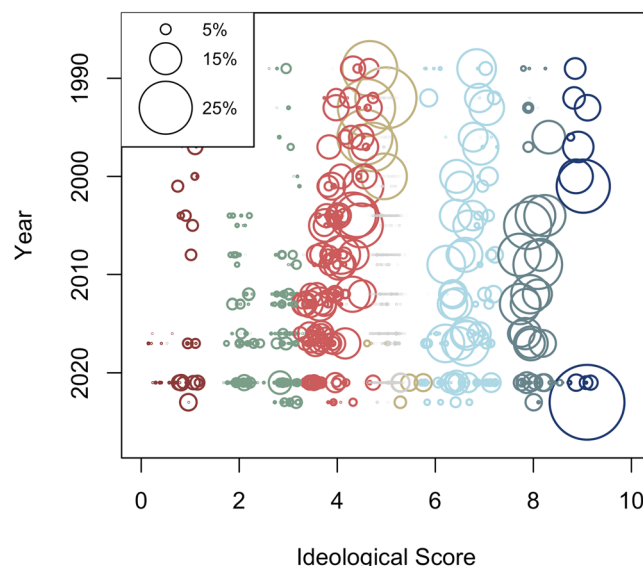


Fig. 3 Asymmetrical fragmentation at the district level in Chile, 1989–2023.

This figure plots all parties that have competed in national elections between 1989 and 2023. The x-axis represents ideological position, and the y-axis represents election year. Bubble sizes correspond to each party's share of the vote at the district level, illustrating asymmetries in party system fragmentation. The visualization shows a higher number of smaller parties on the left and fewer but larger parties on the right, reflecting uneven patterns of electoral competition. Source: Author and Bunker (2025b, 2025c).

parallel on the left and on the right, leaving the balance of representation intact. This scope, in turn, allows fragmentation to be understood as disruptive but not systematically biased.

Figure 3, duplicated from Bunker (2025b), shows an alternative picture. By linking measures of fragmentation such as ENPv and ENPs to ideological categories and electoral returns, it reveals that dispersion has been disproportionately concentrated on the left. In practice, this means left-of-center forces often capitalize on new entrants through complementary lists or coordinated placements, while right-of-center forces more frequently suffer sub-threshold losses or redundant candidacies. These asymmetric outcomes are tied to coalition and party size, with more but smaller parties appearing on the left and less but larger on the right.

The misdiagnosis of symmetry might have shaped both scholarship and reform. By assuming neutral effects, analysts and policymakers may have overlooked how fragmentation was tilting representation over time. This allowed distortions to accumulate, reinforcing ideological imbalances that went largely undetected until they surfaced in moments of crisis. Earlier recognition of asymmetry might have encouraged reforms to thresholds, stronger coordination mechanisms, or recalibrated candidate placement strategies. By neglecting these patterns, opportunities to mitigate representational imbalance were missed, leaving the system more vulnerable to the shocks of 2019 and beyond.

Additional applications. Beyond the application of the CPLD to the context mentioned above, the dataset also enables analyses of other key topics in the study of democracy. For example, the dataset incorporates indicators of social diversity, including ethnic fractionalization and the percentage of ethnic populations at the district level (Hicken & Stoll, 2017; Madrid, 2005; Moser et al., 2018; Raymond et al., 2016; Stoll, 2008). As shown in Fig. 4,

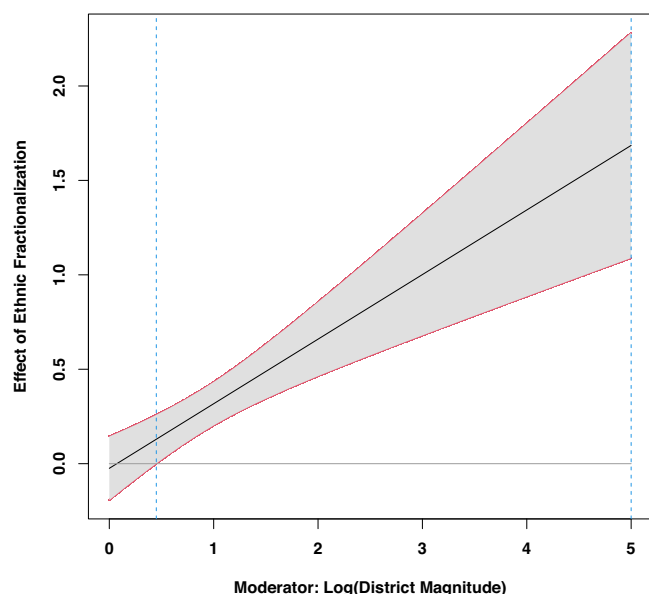


Fig. 4 Social diversity as a determinant of the effective number of parties at the district level in Chile, 1989–2023. This figure illustrates the interaction effect between district magnitude (x-axis) and ethnic fractionalization (y-axis) on the effective number of parties (ENPV) at the district level. The solid line represents the estimated marginal effect of social diversity, while the shaded area indicates the 90% confidence interval. The results suggest that higher levels of ethnic diversity amplify the effect of district magnitude on party system fragmentation. Source: Author and Bunker (2025a).

duplicated from Bunker (2025a), ethnic fractionalization appears to interact with electoral rules to explain fragmentation—as district magnitude increases, the impact of ethnic fractionalization on party system fragmentation increases.

This finding, made using the data from the CPLD, echoes other findings regarding the determinants of the effective number of parties (Teorell & Lindstedt, 2010), and demonstrates how the CPLD allows scholars to test competing hypotheses (see, for example, a rival explanation for the determinants of party system fragmentation in Brazil: Cheibub et al., 2022).

The dataset also facilitates analyses of disproportionality. Multiple indices—such as Rae (1967), Loosemore and Hanby (1971), and Gallagher (1991)—are included, allowing researchers to evaluate how effectively electoral systems translate votes into seats. Figure 5 shows that disproportionality declines as district magnitude increases, consistent with theoretical expectations. Yet the CPLD permits finer-grained analyses, such as whether disproportionality varied across electoral systems, changed after reforms, or was more pronounced in certain regions.

These applications demonstrate the dataset’s versatility. While the three puzzles of fragmentation, ideology, and their interaction motivate this article, the CPLD also offers opportunities to explore broader questions about social cleavages and institutional design. As such, its value lies both in enabling new answers to long-standing debates and in opening avenues for future research across multiple domains of electoral politics, including but not limited to party system nationalization and the determinants of turnout.

Conclusion

This article introduced the Chilean Political Landscape Dataset (CPLD), a new resource that consolidates more than three decades of district-level electoral results across legislative, regional, and municipal arenas. By assembling over 5300 observations and

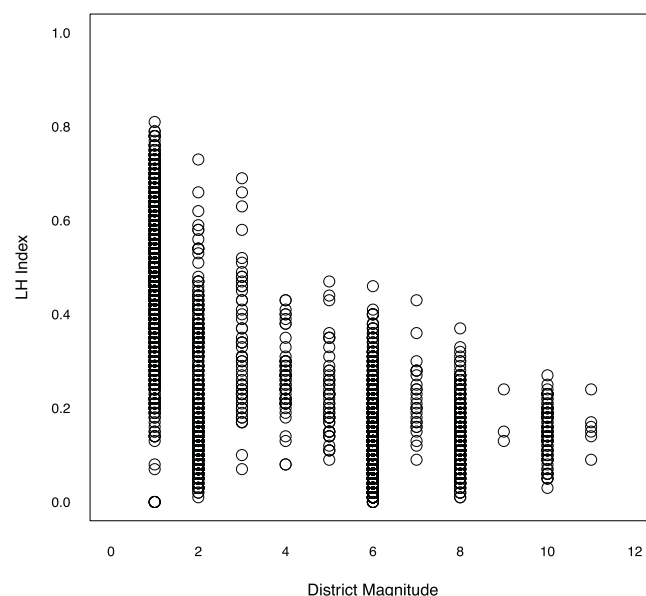


Fig. 5 Vote-seat disproportionality index at the district level in Chile, 1989–2023. This figure plots the Loosemore and Hanby Index of disproportionality (y-axis) against district magnitude (x-axis) across Chilean electoral districts from 1989 to 2023. The descending pattern indicates that larger districts are associated with lower levels of disproportionality, reflecting the tendency of proportional representation to increase with district magnitude. Source: Author with data from the CPLD.

providing consistent measures of party competition, institutional design, and ideological orientation, the dataset fills a longstanding gap in the study of Chilean politics.

The CPLD is not only a descriptive archive but also a tool for addressing central questions in the study of party systems and electoral institutions. Three questions motivated its creation. First, when did fragmentation in Chile’s party system begin? The dominant account associates its emergence with the 2015 legislative reform, yet district-level evidence allows researchers to test whether signs of fragmentation were already visible in earlier elections. Second, has the ideological structure of competition remained stable since the return to democracy, or has it undergone meaningful change? By incorporating information on party orientation, the CPLD makes it possible to evaluate whether Chile’s system has been frozen in place or whether shifts have occurred across time and regions. Third, how are fragmentation and ideology related? The dataset enables analysis that suggests that fragmentation has been asymmetrical across blocs and disproportionately benefited particular sectors, possibly reshaping the balance of representation.

These questions are central not only to understanding Chile but also to engaging with comparative debates. Theories of electoral systems, institutional design, and party system change often rest on assumptions drawn from national aggregates. By providing disaggregated evidence over time, the CPLD allows scholars to evaluate whether those theories hold in a context marked by democratic continuity, repeated institutional reforms, and growing challenges to political representation.

As Chile continues to experience political and institutional transformation, the CPLD provides the empirical foundation for analyzing how these changes affect both national and local competition. Its value lies in enabling precise, theory-driven analysis of fragmentation, ideology, and representation. More generally, it offers a resource for scholars seeking to link electoral

dynamics to broader questions of political development, both within Chile and in comparative perspective.

Data availability

The Chilean Political Landscape Dataset (CPLD), including the accompanying codebook with sources and measurement details, is available on Harvard Dataverse: <https://doi.org/10.7910/DVN/NGRY3R>.

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The authors declare no competing interests.

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This article does not contain any studies with human participants or animals performed by the author. Therefore, ethical approval was not required.

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